

D636

Establishing Positive and Engaging Learning Environments

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

In the third week of school, a fourth-grade teacher in a building with a new gym floor finds that transitions from reading to math take 10 minutes and are chaotic. She posted the transition rule on day one. Her class has 27 students. What should she do?

- A. Model the transition, have students practice it, and give specific feedback until it is smooth.
- B. Move math class to the gym.
- C. Take away recess until transitions improve.
- D. Post the rule in larger print.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An instructional coach tallies a teacher's interactions during a 30-minute lesson in a classroom with new flexible seating: 8 positive statements and 16 corrections. The teacher has a master's degree. What is the ratio and what should change?

- A. 1 positive to 2 corrections; increase specific positives toward at least 4:1.
- B. 2 positives to 1 correction; the ratio is healthy.
- C. 8:16 is fine because the lesson was only 30 minutes.
- D. Remove the flexible seating.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher gives 6 corrections in a lesson. How many positive interactions would she need to reach a 4:1 ratio?

- A. 24
- B. 1.5
- C. 4
- D. 10

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Each time independent writing begins, a sixth grader in a school with a popular chess club tears his paper and is sent to the hallway, where he stays until writing time ends. He is a strong reader. What is the likely function of the behavior?

- A. He is bored because he reads well.
- B. The behavior has no function.
- C. Escape from the writing task; removal is reinforcing it.
- D. Gaining peer attention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's behavior is maintained by escaping hard tasks. Which response best addresses that function?

- A. Give him more attention during the task.
- B. Send him out whenever the behavior happens.
- C. Ignore the behavior completely.
- D. Break the task into smaller parts and teach him to request a short break appropriately.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A student who recently experienced a family crisis shouts and hides under a desk during a fire drill practice. The school was built in 1962 and has a loud alarm. The teacher starts explaining why hiding breaks the rules. What should the teacher do instead?

- A. Continue explaining the rules until the student listens.
- B. Assign a consequence immediately.
- C. Request a newer building with a quieter alarm.
- D. Speak calmly, offer a safe space, and help the student regulate before discussing what happened.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student has calmed down after an outburst and is breathing normally. What is the best next step?

- A.** Never mention the incident, to avoid upset.
- B.** Talk with the student about what happened and plan together for next time.
- C.** Suspend the student.
- D.** Keep coaching calm breathing for the rest of the day.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

Two eighth graders in a school with a new cafeteria menu argue, and one posts an unkind message about the other in a class group chat. The school has 700 students. Which response best reflects restorative practice?

- A.** Suspend the student who posted, with no discussion.
- B.** Tell both students to forget about it.
- C.** Bring both students together to discuss what happened, who was affected, and how to make it right.
- D.** Change the cafeteria seating chart.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

On the first day, a teacher in a school with a strong theater program hands out a list of 15 rules, all starting with “Do not.” The classroom has new whiteboards. Which approach better builds community?

- A.** Write the same rules on the new whiteboards.
- B.** Add five more rules to cover everything.
- C.** Build a short list of positively stated norms with students, based on how they want the class to feel.
- D.** Have no norms at all.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A principal observes a quiet class in a school with a new library: all students are copying notes from slides. The teacher has taught for 18 years. Exit tickets show few students can explain the main idea. How should this lesson's engagement be described?

- A. Emotionally engaged, because it was calm.
- B. Behaviorally compliant but low in cognitive engagement.
- C. Effective, because of the teacher's experience.
- D. Highly engaged, because everyone was on task.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity most increases cognitive engagement in a lesson on the causes of a historical event?

- A. Students sit silently while the teacher lectures.
- B. Pairs rank the causes by importance and defend their ranking.
- C. Students copy the list of causes from the board.
- D. Students color a timeline.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A hybrid high school class, which uses a new video platform, has a discussion board where most students post once and never reply. The class meets online on Mondays. Which step best builds an online learning community?

- A. Require cameras on at all times or lose points.
- B. Assume students will connect over time.
- C. Switch video platforms.
- D. Set clear norms for respectful replies, model a reply, and add a personal welcome and regular teacher responses.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

In the third week of school, a fourth-grade teacher ~~in a building with a new gym floor~~ finds that transitions from reading to math take 10 minutes and are chaotic. She posted the transition rule on day one. ~~Her class has 27 students.~~ What should she do?

Target word: fix the routine **Decides:** The rule was posted, not taught.

A	Correct	Routines must be taught and practiced.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail.
C	Adjacent category	Punishment does not teach the routine.
D	Dropped element	Still not teaching or practicing.

2. Answer A Concept 2

An instructional coach tallies a teacher's interactions during a 30-minute lesson ~~in a classroom with new flexible seating~~: 8 positive statements and 16 corrections. ~~The teacher has a master's degree.~~ What is the ratio and what should change?

Target word: compute and interpret the ratio **Decides:** 8 positives to 16 corrections = 1:2.

A	Correct	8:16 = 1:2, far below 4:1.
B	Inverted operation	Flips the counts.
C	Wrong stem number	Lesson length does not change the ratio.
D	Camouflage	Seating is not what the data show.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A teacher gives 6 corrections in a lesson. How many positive interactions would she need to reach a 4:1 ratio?

Target word: solve for positives **Decides:** Positives = 4 × corrections.

A	Correct	$4 \times 6 = 24$.
B	Confusion set	Divides corrections by 4.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses the ratio number, not the count.
D	Inverted operation	Adds 4 instead of multiplying.

4. Answer C Concept 3

Each time independent writing begins, a sixth grader ~~in a school with a popular chess club~~ tears his paper and is sent to the hallway, where he stays until writing time ends. ~~He is a strong reader.~~ What is the likely function of the behavior?

Target word: identify the function **Decides:** Being sent out removes him from writing.

A	Camouflage	Reading skill does not explain the pattern.
B	Absolute language	Behavior generally serves a purpose.
C	Correct	The consequence gives him what the behavior seeks.
D	Adjacent category	Nothing shows peer attention after the behavior.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A student's behavior is maintained by escaping hard tasks. Which response best addresses that function?

Target word: reverse: pick the matching response **Decides:** Make the task accessible and teach a better way to ask for a break.

A	Confusion set	Targets an attention function, not escape.
B	Inverted operation	Removal gives him the escape he seeks.
C	Adjacent category	Planned ignoring fits attention-seeking, not escape.
D	Correct	Meets the need without rewarding the problem behavior.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A student who recently experienced a family crisis shouts and hides under a desk during a fire drill practice. ~~The school was built in 1962~~ and has a loud alarm. The teacher starts explaining why hiding breaks the rules. What should the teacher do instead?

Target word: trauma-informed response **Decides:** The student is dysregulated.

A	Inverted operation	Reasoning during escalation does not work.
B	Adjacent category	Punishment during dysregulation can escalate.
C	Camouflage	Does not address the student now.
D	Correct	Regulate first; reasoning comes after safety.

7. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

A student has calmed down after an outburst and is breathing normally. What is the best next step?

Target word: reverse: after regulation **Decides:** Now the student can reflect and reconnect.

A	Absolute language	Missing the chance to reflect and reconnect.
B	Correct	Once regulated, reflection and problem-solving can work.
C	Adjacent category	Exclusion does not teach or repair.
D	Dropped element	Stops at regulation and never moves to reflection.

8. Answer C Concept 5

Two eighth graders ~~in a school with a new cafeteria menu~~ argue, and one posts an unkind message about the other in a class group chat. ~~The school has 700 students.~~ Which response best reflects restorative practice?

Target word: restorative response **Decides:** Harm was done to a relationship.

A	Inverted operation	Punishment alone does not repair harm.
B	Dropped element	Leaves the harm unaddressed.
C	Correct	Focuses on harm and repair.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant.

9. Answer C Concept 6

On the first day, a teacher in a school with a strong theater program hands out a list of 15 rules, all starting with "Do not." The classroom has new whiteboards. Which approach better builds community?

Target word: norm-setting approach **Decides:** Teacher-imposed negative rules.

A	Camouflage	Display does not change the approach.
B	Dropped element	Still teacher-made and negative.
C	Correct	Co-created positive norms build ownership.
D	Absolute language	Community needs shared expectations.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A principal observes a quiet class in a school with a new library: all students are copying notes from slides. The teacher has taught for 18 years. Exit tickets show few students can explain the main idea. How should this lesson's engagement be described?

Target word: type of engagement **Decides:** On-task but little thinking.

A	Adjacent category	Calm is not evidence of interest or belonging.
B	Correct	Quiet copying is not deep thinking.
C	Camouflage	Years of experience do not show engagement.
D	Confusion set	Compliance is not engagement.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

Which activity most increases cognitive engagement in a lesson on the causes of a historical event?

Target word: reverse: pick a cognitive task **Decides:** Requires students to reason.

A	Confusion set	Passive, even if calm.
B	Correct	Requires analysis and justification.
C	Inverted operation	Compliance, not thinking.
D	Adjacent category	Active but low in thinking.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A hybrid high school class, which uses a new video platform, has a discussion board where most students post once and never reply. The class meets online on Mondays. Which step best builds an online learning community?

Target word: online community building **Decides:** No interaction norms or presence.

A	Absolute language	A rigid rule does not build community or address the board.
B	Dropped element	Community needs deliberate design.
C	Camouflage	The tool is not the issue.
D	Correct	Norms plus teacher presence invite interaction.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Teach routines explicitly	Routines are taught, modeled, practiced, and reinforced, especially early, rather than just announced.	Posting rules and expecting students to follow them.	Repeated confusion during a transition.
2	Positive-to-corrective ratio	Aim for at least four positive interactions for every correction to build a supportive climate.	Thinking more correction produces better behavior.	Counts of praise and correction statements.
3	Function of behavior	Behavior serves a function, usually to get something (attention, items) or to escape something (tasks, people); responses should address that function.	Using a consequence that gives the student what the behavior was seeking.	A pattern of what happens right after the behavior.
4	Regulate before reason	Trauma-informed practice helps a dysregulated student feel safe and calm before discussing behavior or consequences.	Lecturing or reasoning with a student in the middle of an escalation.	A student who is visibly overwhelmed.
5	Restorative practices	Restorative approaches ask who was harmed and how to repair it, bringing the people involved together.	Equating accountability with punishment or exclusion alone.	A conflict that harmed a relationship.
6	Co-created norms	Norms built with students, stated positively, create shared ownership of the classroom community.	Presenting a long list of teacher-made “don’ts.”	Setting up expectations at the start of a year or unit.
7	Compliance is not engagement	Engagement has behavioral, emotional, and cognitive parts; quiet, on-task behavior is not the same as thinking deeply.	Reading a quiet room as an engaged room.	A class that is calm but producing shallow work.
8	Building community online	In online and hybrid classes, set clear norms for interaction and build teacher and peer presence early and often.	Assuming online students will form community on their own.	Silent discussion boards or cameras-off sessions with no connection.

Course scope (public description): Establishing Positive and Engaging Learning Environments teaches educators how to foster supportive and productive classroom climates. This course delves into the key elements that contribute to creating and maintaining a positive learning atmosphere, such as effective communication, classroom norms and routines, and positive behavior supports. Emphasizing the importance of a safe and inclusive environment, the course explores methods to promote student engagement, collaboration, and mutual respect among learners. It also addresses the role of mental well-being in learning, exploring trauma-informed and restorative practices. These factors are also addressed in relation to online and hybrid learning environments. Through a blend of theoretical frameworks and practical applications including case studies, Establishing Positive and Engaging Learning Environments teaches learners how to develop and sustain environments that not only enhance academic performance but also support the holistic development of students. Candidates will apply theoretical concepts to analyze a classroom environment.